The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra Called "The Wheel of Dedication"

Āryapariṇatacakranāmamahāyānasūtra · Toh 242 · Derge Kangyur
འཕགས་པ་ཡངས་སུ་དག་རྫོགས་འཁོར་ལོ་ཞེས་བྱ་བ་ཐེག་པ་ཆན་པའོ་མདོ

The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra called "The Wheel of Dedication," known in Sanskrit as the Ārya Pariṇatacakra Nāma Mahāyāna Sūtra and in Tibetan as Pakpa Yongsu Ngowé Khorlo, is a short Mahāyāna sūtra found as Toh 242 in the Kangyur, among the general sūtras. Set on the summit of a jewel-and-vajra mountain, it records the Buddha teaching the bodhisattva Vajraratna a liturgy for those who wish to attain great awakening and to gather vast merit. The practitioner offers body and mind to all buddhas and bodhisattvas, laments the bonds of cyclic existence and asks them for refuge, presents immense imagined offerings of jewels, mountains, music and lamps, dedicates the merit to unsurpassed awakening, requests the buddhas to remain in the world, rejoices in the merit of others, and confesses wrongdoing, before reciting a short mantra. The sūtra closes by praising the benefits of reading and reciting this wheel of dedication, and its colophon records that it was translated into Tibetan from a Chinese text, with the help of a monk from Khotan.

In the language of India: ārya pariṇata cakra nāma mahāyāna sūtra. In the language of Tibet: The Noble Great Vehicle Sūtra called "The Wheel of Dedication."

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One (the Buddha) was dwelling on the summit of the Vajra Mountain of Precious Jewels, together with a great retinue of bodhisattva great beings.

Then the Blessed One declared to the bodhisattva Vajraratna: "Son of noble family, a bodhisattva who wishes to strive for great awakening, who wishes to liberate all sentient beings and wishes to hold the bodhisattva vow; who, having generated the mind toward great awakening and being endowed with great compassion, wishes to serve and honor all the tathāgatas; who wishes to gather the vast and extensive accumulation of merit of the bodhisattvas; who wishes to accomplish the wisdom of the buddhas; who wishes to delight in unobstructed dhāraṇīs, meditative absorptions, gateways to liberation, miraculous powers and higher knowledges; who wishes to accomplish a

treasury and great storehouse in the sky; and who wishes to give and offer from his own hand as a wish-fulfilling jewel does, should speak these words:

'All buddhas, blessed ones, who dwell in the ten directions, great bodhisattvas who abide on the ten grounds, and vajra holders, please pay heed to me. I, named so-and-so, not having attained a comfortable abiding on the true path, today generate the mind of awakening. This body and mind of mine, at all times and in every way, I offer as my very body to all the tathāgatas and bodhisattvas of the three times. May the tathāgatas who possess great power and all the bodhisattvas who abide on the great grounds please accept me. May my great accumulations of merit and wisdom, my undertaking of diligence, my broadening of mind, my thorough peace and discipline, my masteries, higher knowledges, perfections and the rest swiftly be brought to completion.

Again, Blessed Ones endowed with great compassion, please pay heed to me. I, named so-and-so, am wandering in saṃsāra, bound by great bonds, dwelling in a prison, cut off from the true path, in the power of the enemy, the afflictions; without protector, without refuge, without eyes, without support, without master, without guide. I have gone astray, I am inclined toward saṃsāra, I have turned my back on great nirvāṇa, I am headed for the lower realms, I keep to bad paths and have fallen onto bad paths. I am always in the grip of bad companions and parted from spiritual friends. I am confused about what is true and what is untrue, what is beneficial and what is not beneficial, what is meaningful and what is meaningless. I am parted from virtuous qualities and have committed great nonvirtue. I have always turned my back on the buddhas, the bodhisattvas and the noble ones. I am tormented by the suffering of birth, aging, sickness and death, and have brought about great misery. I am without fear and without dread, and my mind is always distracted. I am parted from generosity, moral discipline, peaceful solitude and its practice, and from conscientiousness. I am far from the dhāraṇīs, the gateways of meditative absorption, a comfortable abiding in the acceptance of the teachings of the ten grounds, the profound perfection of wisdom, and sameness. I do not practice the four immeasurables of loving-kindness, compassion, joy and equanimity, and I lack the superior moral discipline of a bodhisattva. I am far from the great wisdom that is unattached and unobstructed. I have not attained a comfortable abiding in accomplishing the virtuous qualities that are the cause of nirvāṇa. I am parted from miraculous powers, strengths and fearlessnesses. I do not abide in right mindfulness, and I

do not succeed in engaging with and entering into the nature of reality that is free of forgetfulness. I am lazy in making merit, and through the obscurations of conceited views and doubt I do not realize the seven limbs of awakening, and likewise I do not practice the noble eightfold path. I am overwhelmed by countless hundreds of thousands of afflictions, I suffer many kinds of suffering and am utterly tormented. Always anguished, angry from feebleness of mind, always distracted, I am continually bent toward hundreds of thousands of afflictions. May the tathāgatas and the bodhisattvas who abide in great compassion please be my refuge. Please be my support. Please be my guide. May I swiftly perfect the path of unsurpassed, perfect and complete buddhahood, the path of the great bodhisattvas, and the accumulations of the great bodhisattvas. May I swiftly perfect the ten powers of a tathāgata, the four fearlessnesses, the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha, the unobstructed eloquence in the Dharma of a tathāgata, the meditative absorptions, the dhāraṇīs, the qualities of liberation, the miraculous powers, the higher knowledges and the perfections. And may I be endowed with every excellence of merit.'

At the time of making vast offerings, one should also speak these words: 'Again, all buddhas, blessed ones possessing great power, and all the assemblies of bodhisattvas, please pay heed to me. Today I make offerings and great service to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas, and I offer my body.'

'All the ornaments there are in the world systems of the ten directions, and all fine furnishings: celestial mansions of precious jewels of every kind, all jewel ornaments, jewel trees, jewel mountains, jewel banners, jewel maṇḍalas, strewn jewel treasures, jewel parasols, jewel victory banners, ornaments of jewel necklaces, nets of pearls, jewel vessels, heaps of jewels, radiating jewel light; and on the jewel islands, lamps of great, pure, precious gems; canopies wholly covered with hanging tassels and pendants of radiant precious gems with clasps of refined gold, ringing with the chime of jewel bells; flowers of refined gold with stamens of Jambū river gold; entwined with golden trees; golden palaces gathered with clouds of various jewels; a rain of jewel drops falling; palaces that are treasuries of many kinds of jewels, their walls adorned with gems of divine substance; all the jewel trees, the delightful enclosures of the pleasure groves of the great vidyādharas; the jewel palaces, dwellings, trees, forests and so forth, all of them delightful in this way, which have no owner and are held by no one, all of these I dedicate and offer to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Whatever kinds there are in Jambudvīpa of fine medicines that bring long life and the like; precious gems that fulfill the hopes of all sentient beings; fine food that grows of itself without being tilled; fragrant trees of many kinds; sandalwood trees, aloewood, and red sandalwood; trees of many kinds with great leaves and flowers that ever make things radiant with their scent; delightful incense of divine substance, unclaimed and wholly unclaimed; wish-granting trees of many kinds; the many kinds of precious gems that come from within the great ocean, the wish-fulfilling jewel and the rest; Mount Sumeru, Mount Kailāsa, the Fragrant Mountain, Mount Malaya, Mount Yugaṃdhara, Mount Mahāla, the Vajra Mountain, and so forth, the various jewel peaks of all these great mountains, their jewel terraces, jewel stones, jewel caves, jewel palaces, jewel ornaments, jewel balconies, many jewel avenues, many pillars of precious gems, many wheels of jewel lamps, beryl and many other kinds of gems; all the many delightful and beautiful palaces of the gods and riches of the gods that are in the heavens above with no owner; the many kinds of divine musical instruments that give forth sweet sounds merely when stirred by a breath of wind; sweet music sounding from palaces that stand in the sky; the many kinds of divine instruments that give forth sweet sounds without being played; the various divine birds that give forth various sweet calls from palaces in the sky; the great sweet sounds that come from various jewel clouds; the divine precious gems that resound with melodious tones; and moreover the divine trees of fragrance, the many trees of flowers, the trees of garlands, the many ointments, the trees of incense for burning, the trees of lamps, the trees of victory banners, the trees of banners, the trees of jewels and so forth: all of these, unclaimed and wholly unclaimed, every one of them, I offer to all the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

In the buddha fields seen by the eyes of all the tathāgatas, I offer and present to all those buddhas, blessed ones, and to the great bodhisattvas great clouds of offerings: clouds of flowers, clouds of fragrances, clouds of garlands, clouds of incense, clouds of perfumed ointments, clouds of jewel parasols, clouds of jewel victory banners, clouds of jewel banners, clouds of jewel garments, clouds of jewel forms, clouds of heaps of jewels, and so forth, all these kinds of clouds of great jewels; and moreover great lamp vessels equal in size to a thousandfold world system, filled with fragrant oil, with wicks the size of Mount Sumeru, made into lamps.

Whatever sacred merit there is in making offerings with these many kinds of offerings, all of it I dedicate to unsurpassed awakening. Just as the buddhas,

the blessed ones of the past, undertook much virtue and dedicated it to awakening in a manner free of any object of reference, so do I too dedicate all this merit to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

Again, I make this request: when the buddhas, the blessed ones, having fully and perfectly awakened at the seat of awakening, having turned the great wheel of Dharma, and having defeated the hosts of Māra, intend to pass into nirvāṇa, "For the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings, please remain for a full great eon."

I rejoice in all the merit that all buddhas and bodhisattvas and all sentient beings have accomplished.

Just as all the tathāgatas and bodhisattvas of the three times have confessed all the obscurations of evil deeds and nonvirtuous actions, so do I too fully confess them and fully purify them.'

Having made the offerings, the confession and the rest in this way, one recites this secret mantra one hundred and eight times in the presence of all the buddhas and bodhisattvas, visualized as directly present:

oṃ sambhara sambhara bhimanasara mahājābā hūṃ

Whoever recites that secret mantra will accomplish whatever he wishes, and great clouds of divine offerings and all the tathāgatas too will become manifest.

"If any son of noble family or daughter of noble family, keeping the tathāgatas in mind, reads and recites this great Wheel of Dedication, whether by day or by night, his evil, nonvirtuous actions will be cleansed, all his afflictions will gradually be purified, and he will obtain all those accumulations of merit described above. Even by reading it just once, he will be endowed with the splendor of a hundred Brahmās, and even in his dreams he will always see the buddhas. And after he has died, he will be born in a completely pure field."

When the Blessed One had spoken thus, all those many assemblies of bodhisattvas praised what the Blessed One had said.

This completes the Great Vehicle Sūtra called "The Wheel of Dedication."

It was translated from the Chinese text of the Indian Dharma by Śīladharma, a monk of Khotan versed in the three baskets, and by the venerable Nampar Mitok.

maṅgalaṃ

Here is the Sūtra section, volume Za.

Translator's Notes

• The Sanskrit form Vajraratna for the bodhisattva rdo rje rin po che is a reconstruction from the Tibetan. The name of the mountain where the Buddha dwells, nor bu rin po che rdo rje'i ri, is translated by meaning ("the Vajra Mountain of Precious Jewels"), as no secure Sanskrit name is known.
• "Mount Mahāla" renders ri ma ha la as the Tibetan spells it; the mountain is not securely identified. The Fragrant Mountain (spos kyi ri, Gandhamādana) is given by meaning. The phrase about buddhas intending to pass into nirvāṇa is the standard request that they remain, here phrased as the practitioner's supplication.
• The colophon states that this translation was made from a Chinese text of the Indian scripture. The Tibetan grammar can also be read with the Khotanese monk Śīladharma as the source of the text and the venerable Nampar Mitok as the translator; the rendering above names both as the translators. The final line is the volume label of the Kangyur edition.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.